

RULE BOOK

THE TENNIS CARD GAME · 2–4 PLAYERS · FIRST TO 7

WELCOME TO SLICE!

SLICE! is tennis in a deck of cards. Every card is a shot. Serve, rally and outplay your opponent until someone can't return the ball.

1 · LEARN TO PLAY **P. 3–12**
Everything you need for your first match: groundstrokes, modifiers, serving, the rally and scoring.

2 · POWER SHOTS **P. 13–16**
Volleys, Drop-Shots, Smashes, Lobs, Approaches and the cards that win (or lose) the point.

3 · DOUBLES **P. 17–18**
2 vs 2 with team decks and the Switch!

TIPS & QUICK REFERENCE **P. 19**

New players: read Part 1, then start playing. Look up the power shots the first time someone plays one.

PART 1 · LEARN TO PLAY

IN THE BOX



2 decks of 70 cards, one lime and one orange. Each player uses their own deck.



3 dice: the **Serve Die**, the **Volley Die** and the **Drop-Shot Die**.

WHAT'S IN A DECK

GROUNDSTROKES
Forehands and Backhands, the basic shot. Most of your deck.

TACTICAL
Smash, Lob and Approach.

MODIFIERS
Extra Spin and Soft Touch.

NET CARDS
Volley and Drop-Shot. Roll a die for pace.

SPECIAL
Winner, Error and Good Get.

Part 1 covers groundstrokes and modifiers. The rest are in Part 2.

GROUND-STROKES

The basic shot, just like in tennis. Groundstrokes make up most of your deck, and there are two kinds: **Forehands** and **Backhands**.



COLOR = STROKE

GREEN is a **Forehand**.
ORANGE is a **Backhand**.

NUMBER = PACE

How fast the ball is going. **1** is slow, **7** is a rocket.

ARROW = SPIN

↑ TOPSPIN speeds the ball up.
↓ SLICE slows it down.

SAME PACE, DIFFERENT SHOTS



TOPSPIN FOREHAND 3



FOREHAND SLICE 3



TOPSPIN BACKHAND 3



BACKHAND SLICE 3

SET UP

1. Each player takes a deck and **shuffles** it.
2. Draw a hand of **7 cards**. Keep them hidden from your opponent.
3. Put your deck face down next to you. Keep the **3 dice** where both players can reach them.
4. Flip a coin. The winner **serves first**.

SCORING

Each rally is one **point**. Win it and score 1. **First to 7 points wins the match.**

After each point: discard the cards played, both players draw back up to **7 cards**, and **switch servers**.

THE GOLDEN RULE

Your shot sets the rule for your opponent's return. If they can't return it, you win the point.

Playing 2 vs 2? Learn singles first, then turn to **Doubles** on page 17.

SERVE IT!

Every point starts with a serve. You have two choices:

A **PLAY A GROUNDSTROKE**
Serve any Forehand or Backhand from your hand.

B **ROLL THE SERVE DIE**
Keep your cards and let the die set the pace your opponent must return:



Return at pace **4 or higher**.



Return at pace **5 or higher**.



Return at pace **4 or lower**.



Return at pace **3 or lower**.



LET! See next page.



FAULT! See next page.

A die serve can be returned with a Forehand **or** a Backhand. Only the pace matters.

LET & FAULT



LET

The serve clipped the net. **Both players draw 1 card**, then the server rolls again.



FAULT

The serve missed. Take a **second serve**: roll the Serve Die again.

DOUBLE FAULT

Roll FAULT on your second serve too, and **you lose the point**.

RETURN THE SERVE

The receiver plays a Forehand or Backhand that follows the serve. Now you're in the rally!



SERVE



✓ PACE 6



✓ PACE 5



✕ TOO SLOW

THE RALLY

Take turns returning each other's groundstrokes. Each return must follow these rules.

1 **MATCH THE COLOR**
Forehand returns Forehand. Backhand returns Backhand.

2 ↑ TOPSPIN **SPEEDS IT UP**
Return a Topspin shot with **equal or higher** pace.

3 ↓ SLICE **SLOWS IT DOWN**
Return a Slice shot with **equal or lower** pace.

THEY PLAY A TOPSPIN FOREHAND 5



THEIR SHOT



✓ PACE 6



✕ TOO SLOW



✕ WRONG COLOR

THEY PLAY A BACKHAND SLICE 3

Return with a Backhand of pace **3, 2 or 1**.



? **WILD GROUNDSTROKES**
Choose your pace (1 to 7) when you play it. Then it follows all the normal rules.

SWITCH COLORS

Out of the right color? You can still return a groundstroke.

4 **MATCH THE PACE EXACTLY**
Return a groundstroke with a groundstroke of the **other color** and the **same pace**. The spin doesn't matter.



THEIR SHOT



✓ PACE 4



✓ PACE 4



✕ NOT 4

Switching colors changes the game. Now your opponent has to follow **your** color and **your** spin.

Groundstrokes only. Net, tactical and special cards have their own rules (Part 2).

THE RALLY RULES

- **1** Match the color.
- **2 ↑** Topspin: equal or higher pace.
- **3 ↓** Slice: equal or lower pace.
- **4 =** Other color? Match the pace exactly (groundstrokes only).

MODIFIER CARDS

Change the pace of your shot. Play a modifier together with the card you're playing.



EXTRA SPIN +1

Adds 1 to the pace of the card you play it with.

They hit a **Topspin Forehand 6**. Your Topspin Forehand 5 + Extra Spin **counts as a 6**. ✓



SOFT TOUCH −1

Takes 1 off the pace of the card you play it with.

They hit a **Backhand Slice 3**. Your Topspin Backhand 4 + Soft Touch **counts as a 3**. ✓

1. **One modifier per shot.** Your card keeps its color and spin.
2. Pace always stays between **1 and 7**.
3. Then **draw 1 card** to replace the modifier.

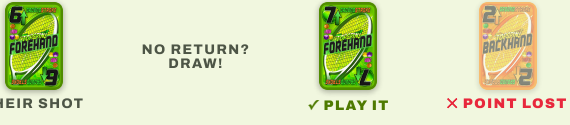
KEEP IT ALIVE!

LAST DITCH EFFORT

No legal return in your hand? Draw the top card of your deck.

- ✓ **It's a legal return?** Play it. The rally goes on!
- ✓ **It's a modifier** that makes a card in your hand legal? Play them together (page 10).
- ✗ **Anything else?** You lose the point. Keep the card in your hand.

LAST DITCH EFFORT EXAMPLE



THEIR SHOT ✓ PLAY IT ✗ POINT LOST

DIG DEEP

Used your last card in a rally? Dig Deep: draw cards from your deck and keep playing.

1ST TIME	2ND TIME	AFTER THAT
Draw 3	**Draw 2**	**Draw 1**

Playing it or discarding it with a Good Get both count. If an Approach steals it, try a Last Ditch Effort instead. Counts reset every point.

A POINT, SHOT BY SHOT

ALEX 

Serves with the die: **Topspin 5**. Sam must return at pace 5 or higher.

SAM 

Plays a **Forehand Slice 6**. Alex needs a Forehand of 6 or lower.

ALEX 

Plays a **Topspin Forehand 3**. Sam needs a Forehand of 3 or higher.

SAM 

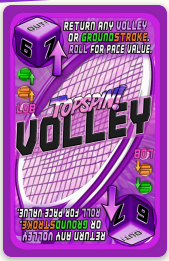
Nothing in hand works. **Last Ditch Effort!** Sam draws a **Backhand Slice 3**. Same pace, so it's legal. **The rally goes on!**

ALEX 

Alex needs a Backhand of 3 or lower, or a Forehand 3. Nothing. **Last Ditch Effort!** Alex draws a **Topspin Backhand 5**. **Too fast.**

Sam wins the point, 1–0. Both refill to 7 cards and Sam serves next.

VOLLEY



PLAY IT

Return **any groundstroke or Volley**, whatever its pace.

ROLL FOR PACE

Roll the **Volley Die**. The roll is your Volley's pace.

THE VOLLEY DIE

6	Return at **6 or higher**.
7	Return at **7**.
NET!	**NET!** You lose the point.
OUT!	**OUT!** You lose the point.

TO RETURN A VOLLEY

Play a **Volley**, a **Smash**, or any groundstroke with pace **equal or higher** than the roll.

DROP-SHOT



PLAY IT

Return **any groundstroke or Drop-Shot**, whatever its pace.

ROLL FOR PACE

Roll the **Drop-Shot Die**. The roll is your Drop-Shot's pace.

THE DROP-SHOT DIE

1	Return at **1**.
2	Return at **2 or lower**.
NET!	**NET!** You lose the point.
OUT!	**OUT!** You lose the point.

TO RETURN A DROP-SHOT

Play a **Drop-Shot**, a **Lob**, or any groundstroke with pace **equal or lower** than the roll.

Net cards are a gamble. They can end the point fast, for either player.

TACTICAL CARDS



SMASH PUNISHES A WEAK BALL

Play it on a **pace 1 or 2** shot.

To return it: a groundstroke with pace **equal or higher** than the Smash, or a **Lob**.



LOB BEATS POWER

Play it on a **pace 6 or 7** shot.

To return it: a groundstroke with pace **equal or lower** than the Lob, or a **Smash**.





APPROACH STEAL A CARD

Play the **Topspin Approach 5** on a pace 5 shot, or the **Approach Slice 3** on a pace 3 shot. Then **steal 1 random card** from your opponent.

To return it: ↑5 pace 5 or higher. ↓3 pace 3 or lower.

SPECIAL CARDS



WINNER!

Play it on a shot of pace **3, 4 or 5**. **You win the point.** No return.



ERROR!

Play it on a shot of pace **1, 2, 6 or 7**. **You lose the point.**



GOOD GET!

Return **any** shot, at any pace. Then discard 1 card.

To return it: play **any card**.

Discarded your last card? **Dig Deep** (page 11).

Save your Winner for a big moment. A pace 3, 4 or 5 ball comes up in almost every rally.

PART 3 · 2 VS 2

DOUBLES

SET UP

1. Make 2 teams of 2. Each team shares **one 70-card deck**.
2. Each player draws **5 cards**. Want longer rallies? Draw **7**.

TAKE TURNS

Players return shots in this order, around and around:

TEAM A · P1 → TEAM B · P1 → TEAM A · P2 → TEAM B · P2

The server rotates in the same order, one new server each point.

TALK IT OVER

Partners can talk **before the point**. Once the serve is played, **no talking** until the point is over.

SAME RULES, SAME SCORE

Every singles rule still applies. After each point, everyone refills to 5 (or 7). **First team to 7 points wins.**

SWITCH!

Stuck on your turn? Call **"Switch!"** Each team gets one Switch per point.

1. Your partner looks at the shot on the table and picks **1 card** they think can return it.
2. They pass it to you **face down**. You pass **1 card** back face down.
3. Pick up your new card and **take your turn**. A Switch doesn't use up your turn.

STILL STUCK?
Try a **Last Ditch Effort**, just like singles. Your team can't Switch again for the rest of the point.

PARTNER TIP

No talking during the point, so watch the shot on the table. If your partner calls Switch, you already know what they need.

COACH'S TIPS

1. **Slow down a big hitter.** A low-pace Slice forces them to stay low too.
2. **Hold a Lob** for a 6 or 7 rocket, and a **Smash** for a 1 or 2 floater.
3. **Switch colors** to leave your opponent without a return.
4. **Net cards are a gamble.** Use them when you'd lose the point anyway.
5. **Doubles:** plan during the talk time. Once the serve is played, you're on your own.

QUICK REFERENCE

↑ Topspin: same color, **equal or higher** pace.

↓ Slice: same color, **equal or lower** pace.

= Other color groundstroke: **match the pace**.

VOLLEY Roll. Return equal or higher.

DROP Roll. Return equal or lower.

WINNER on 3–5 wins. **ERROR** on 1, 2, 6, 7 loses.

STUCK? Last Ditch Effort: draw 1 and try it.

LAST CARD? Dig Deep: draw 3, then 2, then 1.



TENNIS WITH A TWIST!

2–4 PLAYERS · SINGLES & DOUBLES · AGES 8+

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